



Customise your DivX movie CD

Insert a CD and get DivX to autorun. Get a synopsis of the movie. Browse online film reviews. Play around with lots more by customising your DivX movie CD

Ripping a DVD movie to DivX has now become passé. It's time to elevate yourself to the next level. Customize your DivX movie CDs so that once you insert a disk in your drive, it not only auto-runs, but also provides you with a menu so that you can do more things related to the movie like reading a synopsis of the movie

or launching a browser to go directly to online reviews. And no, you do not require programming knowledge for accomplishing this—just 30 minutes.

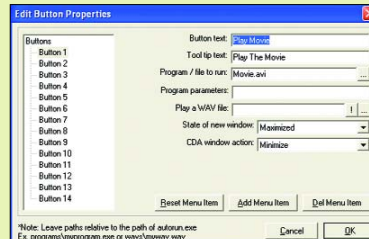
To create this menu we will be using a freeware tool called Compact Disc Autorun (CDA) available on the web (www.utdallas.edu/~jbs024000/software/cda.html) and some other software that will make the menu look better, and display images such as the DVD front and back covers.

1 STEP First, download the CDA compressed archive, and extract the executable to the folder where you have your movie. When you run the program you should see an interface as shown.

Whew! That's a lot of buttons. But don't worry, once you start, it'll be a walk in the park.

2 STEP Click on the first button and you will get a lot of options to configure that button. Here's how we did it. We chose to keep the first

have the images of the back and front DVD covers create buttons for them too. If you have a small synopsis text file, create a button for that. Our menu resembled this box below.



Each button can be customised to perform a specific function

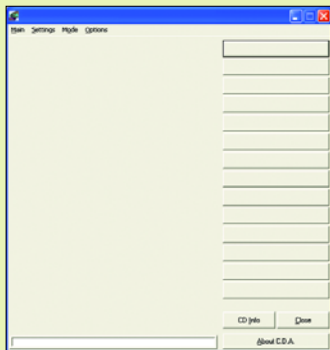
button as the 'Play Movie' button. Provide the path of the movie and that's it. You're done!

3 STEP Customising comes next. Play around with the buttons as you like. If you want to keep a codec pack handy on the CD, copy the codec installer in the same folder as the executable and create a button for it. If you

4 STEP Now for the final touches. With the buttons created, click on Settings > Sound & other option. This will let you configure the options for the main window. If you want to display any images, click on the Settings > Image properties option and provide the path to the image to be displayed. Then click on Settings > Test Settings. This will give you a status report of the work that you have done and whether anything is wrong. If everything is OK, click on Settings > Save to current directory. Then click on Settings > Create INF and finally click on Settings > Make Settings read only.

5 STEP Burn all the files that you see to a CD. Make sure that all the files, including the movie and the auto-run files are on the root of the CD. If there are any folders, make sure that you specify the path correctly. Once you have the movie on the CD, try it out and let us know if your friends are amazed to see what you have just created!

Note: Find the software mentioned here and more similar freeware on our DVD/CD.



The CD interface, with the buttons



The final interface that appears when you enter the CD in the drive



Virus Alerts, Bug Fixes, Patches, Security

Virus Workshop

www.zdnetindia.com/digital